

Founder Circle.



COHORT PROFILE 2026

A Note on Founder Circle



The **Nalanda Mahavihara**, featured on our cover, represents a historic tradition of bringing together students, scholars and thinkers to learn, exchange ideas and grow together. Founder Circle is inspired by that same spirit.

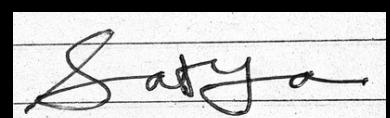
From 140 applicants, only 14 individuals have been selected for this inaugural cohort, representing an acceptance rate of 10%. Each member brings a different background, experience and ambition, but all share a willingness to learn, contribute and build.

Through **virtual masterclasses and in-person meetups across India**, we aim to create a space where members can exchange experiences, challenge ideas, find collaborators and turn conversations into action.

Our ambition goes beyond creating a network. We hope the people in this cohort go on to build startups that solve meaningful problems and create real impact for humanity, with some growing into companies that reach millions and perhaps even become unicorns.

This is where we begin. What we build from here is up to us.

Satya Prakash Samal
Founding Member, Founder Circle



The Idea

What if ambitious students did not
have to build alone?

LEARN

Access
knowledge from
people who are
already building.

CONNECT

Find people who
understand the
ambition to build.

BUILD

Turn conversations into things that exist.

Find collaborators, validate ideas,
experiment with projects and build
startups together.

The Inaugural Cohort

140

(APPLICANT MEMBERS)

14

(SELECTED MEMBERS)

10%

(ACCEPTANCE RATE)

Meet the Cohort



Founder Circle | Cohort 2026

SOWMYA DURGA JAMI



FOUNDER @
WINWIN
FINEXPERTS

CURRENT FOCUS

Founder, WINWIN FINEXPERTS
Financial Consulting · Hyderabad

EXPERIENCE

Runs a finance consultancy helping businesses with funding, debt management and risk solutions, with 10,000+ individuals and entrepreneurs assisted.

ASHI SHARMA



BUILDING MINDS

CURRENT FOCUS

Public Speaking & Mind Training
Content Creation · Education

EXPERIENCE

Creates content on optimism, growth, motivation and public speaking, while working on public speaking and mind-training ideas with his father.

K. VAISHNAVI REDDY



WEB DEVELOPER

CURRENT FOCUS

Web Developer & Content Creator
Marketing · Seeking Startup Internship

EXPERIENCE

Builds websites for local businesses and creators, with experience in web development, content creation, communication and marketing.

PAVNI KHURANA



EXPLORING BUSINESS & LAW

CURRENT FOCUS

Business & Entrepreneurship · Business Law · Startup Opportunities

EXPERIENCE

Exploring entrepreneurship and seeking practical startup exposure, with strengths in public speaking, creative writing and design.

PURNANGSHU BOSE



FOUNDER @
CHAIOLIC

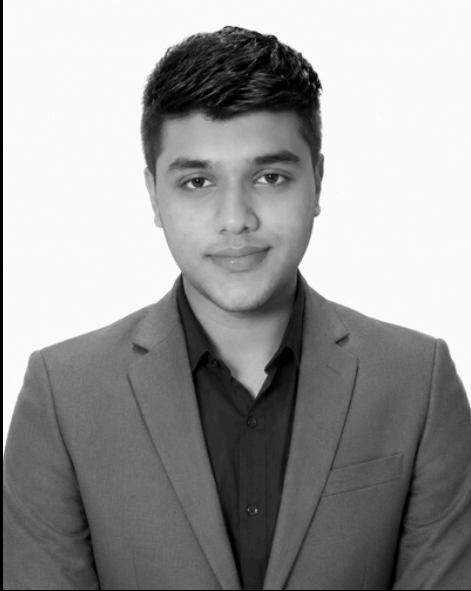
CURRENT FOCUS

Founder, Chaioolic
Food & Beverage · Kolkata

EXPERIENCE

Founded Chaioolic, a Kolkata-based workplace F&B solutions startup serving corporates and coworking spaces through pantry management, fresh food, tea, coffee and beverage vending solutions.

SIDDHARTHA RAY



VENTURE BUILDER

CURRENT FOCUS

Founder & Startup Builder

AI · Finance & Banking · MVP Stage

EXPERIENCE

Built multiple ventures across events, streetwear and digital growth, including DARK GRAY, while now developing a data-driven AI business intelligence startup.

AYUSH H MOGAVEERA



BUILDING THROUGH RESELLING

CURRENT FOCUS

Finance & Banking · Startup Opportunities
· Financial Modelling

EXPERIENCE

Resold iPhones for ₹50K and later built a diecast reselling business exceeding ₹1 lakh in sales.

KARAN AGGARWAL



BUILDING FOCUS TOOLS

CURRENT FOCUS

EdTech · Productivity · Finance & Banking

EXPERIENCE

Building OnPace, a student productivity platform under LaunchX incubation. Also a finalist at E-Cell IIT Bombay's Eureka Junior and organized a MUN generating ₹30K in revenue.

AKSHAR PATEL



FOUNDER @
FUELOCAL

CURRENT FOCUS

Founder, Fuelocal

AI · Sports Nutrition · MVP Stage

EXPERIENCE

Building Fuelocal, an AI-powered sports nutrition platform for Indian athletes, with a website, initial app and 50+ athlete waitlist.

RAJ KRISHNA VERMA



BUILDING STUDENT ECOSYSTEM

CURRENT FOCUS

Building a Student Ecosystem Platform
Real Estate · Student Services · MVP Stage

EXPERIENCE

Experience in real estate and hostel management, while building a student marketplace for accommodation, roommates and campus services.

RAJ BHARDAN KUMAR



BUILDING THROUGH CONTENT

CURRENT FOCUS

Marketing & Advertising ·
Entrepreneurship · Consumer Psychology

EXPERIENCE

Built an anime-focused YouTube channel to 3K+ subscribers in 15 days, later contributing to content ideation and scripting for 20+ videos generating 5M+ long-form views.

ABHIVYAKT PATIDAR



BUILDING FOOD PRODUCTS

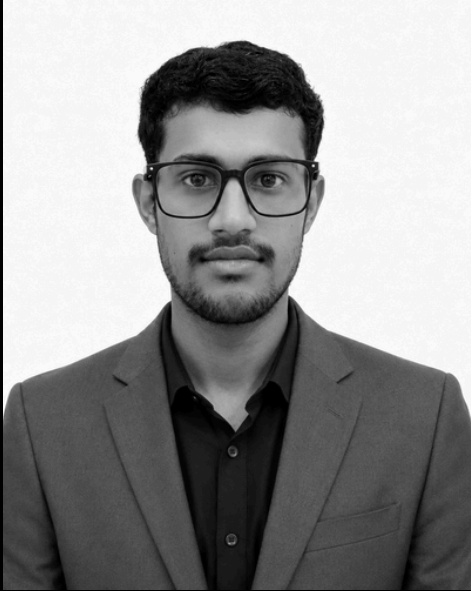
CURRENT FOCUS

Entrepreneur · Food & Agri Products
Solar Energy · Food Processing · MVP

EXPERIENCE

Runs a commercial solar plant business and is developing a food-processing venture focused on dehydrated fruits, vegetables and food powders.

SAJAN SINGH RATHORE



CREATING WITH PURPOSE

CURRENT FOCUS

Finance & Banking · Manufacturing ·
Business Growth

EXPERIENCE

Aspiring entrepreneur inspired by technology, manufacturing and innovation, with a focus on creating businesses that generate employment and contribute to society.

SATYA PRAKASH SAMAL



BUILDING FOR HUMANITY

CURRENT FOCUS

Entrepreneurship · Artificial Intelligence ·
Digital Products

EXPERIENCE

Founded ventures in private messaging, e-commerce and gaming, building products and communities.

Founder Circle.

Profiles have been compiled from information submitted by members. Descriptions, visuals, and the stated acceptance rate may contain unintended inaccuracies and are intended for community purposes only.